

The text addresses the question of what information visualization is and how it works. Manovich explains the rules of visualization and shows new ways to use data in visual form.

Manovich claims that information visualization always uses two main ideas: reduction and space. This means we make data simpler and we use position and size to show the most important information.

This paper approaches the topic by first giving a definition, then showing examples like bar charts, network maps, and new projects like Cinema Redux. Some questions this raises are: Is it always necessary to make data simpler to understand it? Can we show data without changing it? Does the way we present data always affect the meaning we find in it?

In my opinion, the idea of "direct visualization" is very interesting because it keeps the original data instead of replacing it with simple shapes.

The Frank Lloyd Wright radial tree we made in group study is a good example in which we used the real building names and city names instead of just numbers or dots. This makes the visualization more meaningful and easier to connect to real life.